

ALESSIA PAPINI

Department of Economics, European University Institute
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EDUCATION

- 2025– Ph.D. in Economics, European University Institute
 Supervisors: Profs. Giancarlo Corsetti and Alexander Ludwig
- 2024–25 Master of Research in Economics, European University Institute
- 2021–23 M.Sc. in Economic and Social Sciences, Università Bocconi
 Supervisor: Prof. Tommaso Monacelli Final Grade: 110/110 cum Laude
- 2018–21 B.A. in Economics, Università degli Studi di Firenze Final Grade: 110/110 cum Laude

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Macroeconomics, Household Finance, Expectation Formation, Fiscal and Monetary Policy

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Fiscal Policy and Household Over-Optimism”

Presented at: EUI 2nd Year Forum

Abstract: This paper studies whether fiscal policy transmits to the economy through a sentiment channel. The post-pandemic European fiscal regime shift moved household credit-access beliefs across the euro area. I study Italy, where the Draghi credibility event of February 2021 provides a sharp, datable domestic amplification of the common European shock. Using the ECB Consumer Expectations Survey, I construct individual-level credit-access forecast errors and estimate their response with the Forecasted Average Treatment estimator, designed for settings of universal treatment. I document systematic and persistent over-optimism: forecast errors increase by up to 7.8 percent of the survey scale, peaking several months after the announcement before gradually declining. Finally, I show that over-optimistic beliefs are associated with active credit-seeking behavior: a one-unit increase in the forecast error is associated with a 0.78 percentage-point higher probability of applying for credit in the subsequent quarter.

“Mass Layoff Announcements and Consumption Behavior” *with Ludovic Roussel*

“Education Expansion, Fertility and Human Capital” *with Daniel Jaar and Saverio Lenzi*

PUBLICATIONS

Guerini, C., Masciandaro, D. & Papini, A. “Literacy and Financial Education: Private Providers, Public Certification and Political Preferences.” *Italian Economic Journal*, 2024.
[doi:10.1007/s40797-024-00287-1](https://doi.org/10.1007/s40797-024-00287-1)

Borghi, E., Masciandaro, D. & Papini, A. “European Politicians and Financial Literacy Activism: Does Financial (In)Stability Matter?” *Economics Letters*, 2024.
[doi:10.1016/j.econlet.2024.111981](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.econlet.2024.111981)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2025 Research Assistant to Profs. Giancarlo Corsetti and Saverio Simonelli, European University Institute
- 2023–24 Research Assistant to Profs. Donato Masciandaro, Elisa Borghi and Magda Bianco (Bank of Italy), Baffi-Carefin Centre, Università Bocconi
- 2022–23 Research Assistant to Prof. Tommaso Monacelli, Università Bocconi

Feb–Apr 2023 Research Intern in Monetary Policy, Baffi-Carefin Centre, Università Bocconi

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

2025 Bank of Italy Grant for Female Economists
2024 Italian Grant for Master of Research Students, European University Institute
2022 Premio di Laurea Lorenzo Bruni, Università degli Studi di Firenze — Best Undergraduate in Economics, A.Y. 2020/21
2022 Premio America Giovani, UNAI — Full Tuition Waiver. Top 1,000 Italian graduates of A.Y. 2020/21

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Fall 2025–2026 Teaching Assistant, *Macroeconomics I* (PhD), European University Institute
 Prof. Alexander Ludwig
2024–25 Teaching Assistant, *International Economics* and *Microeconomics*, Politecnico di Milano
 Profs. Giulia Felice and Lucia Tajoli
Feb–Jun 2022 Tutor, TOP Project, Fondazione CIAI — Bocconi University / Harvard University

SKILLS

Programming: Stata, R, L^AT_EX, Python, Gretl, MATLAB, QGIS
Languages: Italian (native), English (C1), French (B1)